

Recess with Reycraft

Tradition for the birds

By JACK REYCRRAFT

One of the myths which have been accepted as reality by many of us is the claim that the owl is a wise old bird. They do look rather intelligent, which is probably why someone wrote that poem about the wise old owl who sat in an oak and listened far more than he spoke and asked why we all can't do likewise. Well frankly, I'd much rather sit in an armchair and do at least half the talking.



Jack Reycraft

The fact is that owls aren't very intelligent at all. As a night hunter, it all too often lets out a cry of joy as it flies toward its prey, and the prey hears the warning and escapes.

In the Near East, many of the proverbs label the owl a moron, and anyone would be indignant if someone else compared him to one. It isn't clear who started the opposite rumor in our civilization — probably the same guy who called mules stupid just because they're stubborn.

Several years ago there was a screech owl which nested in the eaves of the Staten Island Museum in St. George. It stayed there for quite a while, but never made friends with anyone. On the other hand, pigeons are much friendlier, particularly when a group of children eats lunch outside after a tour.

How did you break your husband of staying out late at night?" Smerda Strolq asked a neighbor. "Well, when he came home late one night, I called, 'Is that you, Clarence?' and it worked," the neighbor replied. "Because my husband's name is George."

WEST BRIGHTON native George Genovese and his brother Frank (Chick) Genovese are both scouts for the San Francisco Giants baseball team after careers as players and managers too. Naturally they do a great deal of traveling in their quest for talent. Chick now lives in Orlando, Fla., and George and his family reside in North Hollywood, Calif. Just recently George was in El Paso, Texas, and had a reunion with Andy Cohen, who was a famed second baseman with the New York Giants in

the late 1920s, with a batting average of 281. George was told that Andy Cohen's wife is a descendant of the Van Duzer family, which settled on Staten Island in the 17th century and for whom one of our prime streets is named.

Marge (Port Richmond) Ouellette has been busy as information officer of the National Horseshoe Pitching Association of America. She had much to do with a session in Manhattan in which the two champions were on TV and held a clinic in Central Park, and she's compiling a directory of courts and clubs throughout the country. Anyone interested in participating in the association may contact her at Post Office Box 1977, New York, N.Y. 10017.

Birthday wishes today are for Dr. Cecil Mantell, George Latanzio Jr., Richard Nusser, Rossiline Thomas and Priscilla Thomassen. Tomorrow's greetings go to retired Detective John C. Schoenstein, Charles Kealy, Violet Jackson and Anna Magnussen.

TODAY'S a smilestone for Peter and Susan (Dongan Hills) Fischetti and Jack and Angela (West Brighton) Corso ... Tomorrow's an anniversary for William and Lucille (New Dorp) Waters ... William and Patricia Damrow and their daughter Jessica are pleasant additions to the Great Kills scene. He's a student at the Lutheran Theological Seminary in Philadelphia and serving a year of internship at Christ Lutheran Church here ... Dick and Jean (Grasmere) Muller are home after a visit in Fort Lauderdale, Fla., with their son and daughter-in-law, Carl and Susan Muller. Carl just passed his bar examination and is now a practicing attorney there ... The Staten Island Kiwanis Club had to reschedule its visit to a Yankee baseball game because of Monday's deluge.

From Canada comes belated word of the death of Prof. Robert W. Cumberland, 80, in St. Mary's Hospital, Kingston, Ontario, on July 1. A longtime Island resident while on the faculty of Cooper Union for the Advancement of Science and Art in Manhattan, he retired in 1961 and left for his native Canada. He and his wife, Elizabeth, who survives, made their home in Bath, Ontario. The professor was active in community organizations while he lived here.